Ivan the terrible
the first tsar of Russia

His Name: In Russian, "Terrible" means "Powerful," but he was very violent.

Cruelty to Animals: As a child, he liked to throw cats and dogs from **high buildings**.

Birth: He was born on August 25, **1530**.

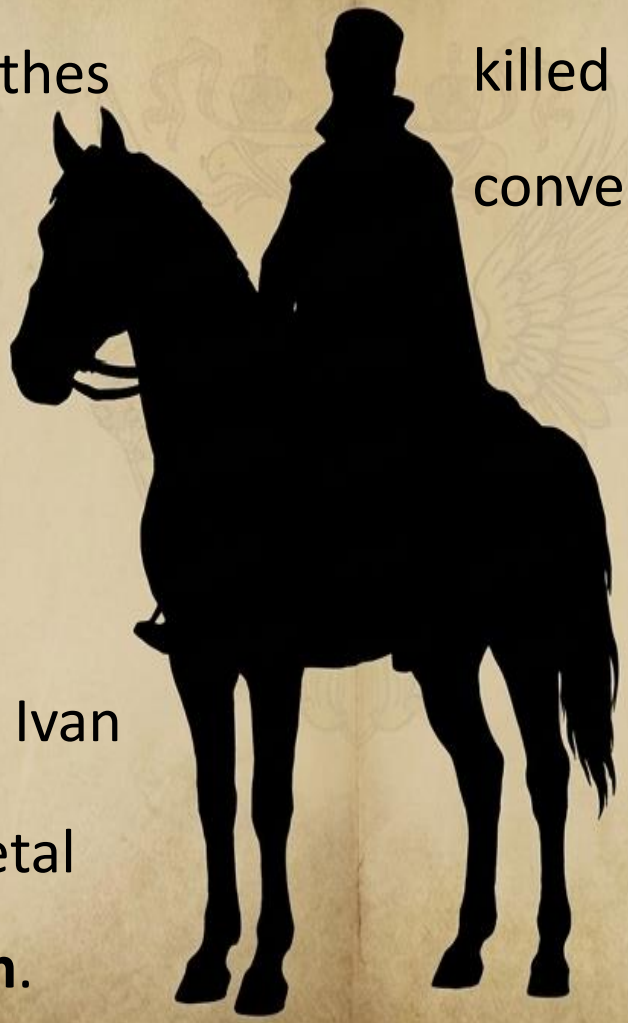
Death: He died on March 28, **1584**, while playing **chess**.

Sad Childhood: His father died when he was 3, and his mother died when he was 8. He grew up alone and angry..

Secret Police: He created a group of men in black clothes who rode black horses to kill his enemies.

Killed His Son:

In a moment of anger, Ivan hit his son with a metal staff and **killed him**.



Seven Wives: He married **7 times**. Most of his wives were killed or sent away to live in convents.

Lost Library: He had a huge library of rare books, but it disappeared after he died. **No one has found it yet.**

Fake Resignation: Once, he said he was leaving the throne. People got scared and **begged** him to come back. **He came back with more power..**

His Look: In his old age, he **looked** very **tired**, **bald**, and had very **scary eyes**.

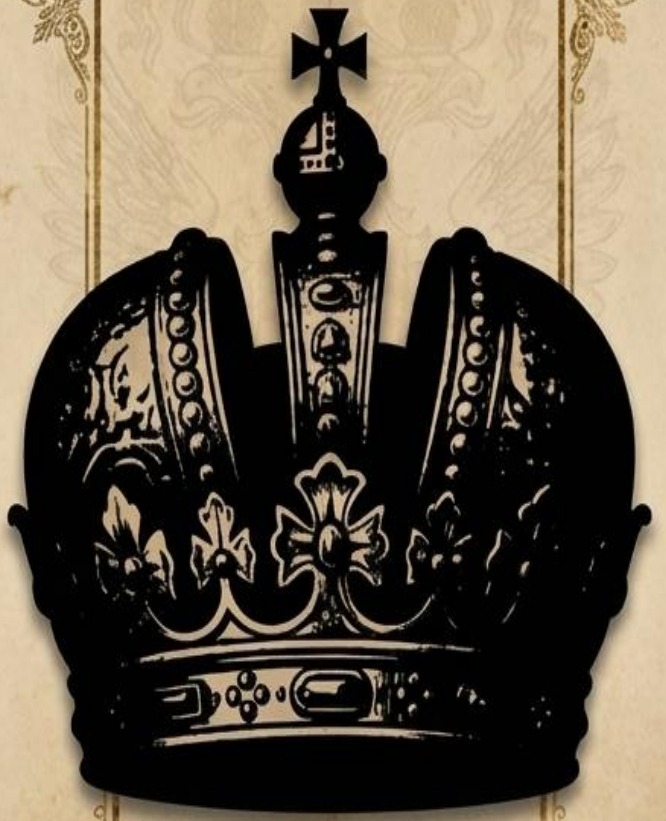
End of the Family: Because he killed his strongest son, his **family line** ended soon after his death.

Mercury Poisoning: Scientists found a lot of **mercury** in his body. This might be why he was so angry and crazy.

Growing Russia: He made Russia much bigger by winning many wars and taking new lands.

Smart and Talented:

Even though he was violent, he was very smart, loved music, and wrote many letters.



Paranoia:

In his last years, he was very afraid and thought everyone wanted to **poison him**.